

Application for Advanced Associate, Internal Audit, Controls, Compliance and Risk

Dear Pearson Early Careers Team,

I am applying for the Internal Audit graduate programme in London because it offers something rare in a first role: a view of how an entire global organisation actually works, rather than one corner of it.

Auditing across financial processes, technology, cyber, HR and AI is the fastest way I can think of to understand how an organisation fits together, and I am attracted to the fact that the output is not just a finding but a recommendation a senior leader can act on. I am available to start by July 2027 and I am ready to commit to the ACCA qualification alongside the work.

My academic background is an MSc in Information Security from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, with Security Management, Critical Infrastructure Security and Secure Business Architectures among the modules, preceded by a BCA in computer applications covering Python, Java, JavaScript, MySQL and AI and machine learning. I hold CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity. A STEM route into internal audit means I arrive with the analytical and technical grounding your technology and AI audits need, and I am genuinely interested in the assurance side of that work - understanding whether a control is designed well, whether it is operating, and what evidence proves it.

I already operate controls rather than only studying them. In my current IT support role I handle four to five access requests a day through on-premises Active Directory, and the process is a control loop: I verify that business approval exists, grant only time-limited permissions, then document the access period and any extension. I investigate four to five suspicious emails a day, checking sender and link domains for impersonation, recording findings and flagging recurring tactics to colleagues. Alongside that I built a local tool that maps Windows error codes to their common causes and used it to trace intermittent server freezes to errors associated with missing or corrupted DLLs, informing the corrective action taken. Testing whether something works, evidencing it, and recommending the fix is the same instinct your audit plan runs on.

The reporting and stakeholder half of audit is where I have the most to build, and I would rather say that plainly. What I do have is practice at making findings land with people who did not ask for them. At Co-op, as Person in Charge, I conduct weekly store-wide risk assessments and daily compliance checks, review operational controls and maintain the assessment records, while coordinating seven or eight colleagues per shift and explaining control requirements to people with no particular interest in them. I also use Excel, Word and PowerPoint daily for reporting and records. I am careful with detail by habit: in my SafePaste project I ran over 150 manual test cases to 93.7% accuracy and deliberately hunted false positives, because a control that flags the wrong thing costs more than it catches.

What attracts me to Pearson specifically is the breadth of the three-year programme and the fact that audits over the use of AI in the business are part of the plan. I have built with AI and I have seen where its outputs need validating, which should help me ask useful questions about how it is governed. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background could contribute to your audit team.

Kind regards,

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